1 Overview

This chapter covers

- Setting the scene for modern search engines
- Introducing Elasticsearch
- Understanding Elasticsearch's core areas, use cases, and prominent features
- The Elastic Stack: Beats, Logstash, Elasticsearch, and Kibana

The explosion of data in recent years has led to a new normal in terms of the standards expected of search and analytics functionality. As organizations amass data, the ability to find the "needle in the haystack" is a paramount necessity. In addition to search, being able to zoom out and aggregate data using analytical functionality has become a mandatory requirement for organizations. The last decade has seen exponential adoption of modern search and analytics engines. One such modern search engine is Elasticsearch.

Elasticsearch is a powerful and popular open source distributed search and analytics engine. It is built on top of the Apache Lucene library and can perform near-real-time search and analytics on structured and unstructured data. It is designed to handle large amounts of data efficiently.